

Cover to *Captain America (2004) #23* by Steve Epting and Frank D'Armata.



Cover to *Black Panther (2005) #22* by Mike Deodato and Dean White.

making a decision for the first time that's personal over sort of a global version of doing the right thing. Once he does that, once you hook into this idea of Steve Rogers really doing something for himself, it becomes a story that I think, again, is more relatable. And it's that idea of 'How far will you go to rescue your best friend?' Here is Bucky Barnes, who was the Winter Soldier for 80 years—who, in his own way, was a prisoner of war. The idea of choice was taken away from him. The idea of self-determination was taken away from him. And Steve, I think, still sees that glimmer of Bucky Barnes in the Winter Soldier. I think audiences will really plug into this idea of going that extra mile for something you really believe in, and being a beacon of hope and morality so that other characters rally around him."

When Barnes seemingly plants a bomb at the U.N., killing many important officials, Captain America seeks to save him before the government can capture and possibly kill him. Tony leads the charge to apprehend Steve, but he isn't the only one seeking justice. "So much of the ***Civil War*** story is told from Captain America's point of view. We've brought in Tony Stark to showcase that other side of that argument, and it's really the two of them and the people that team up with them," Feige elaborates. "But at the same time we thought it would be fun to introduce a third side, to introduce a character that audiences have wanted for many, many years, who comes in and is really not agreeing with either side in particular and can represent sort of fresh eyes to see Tony's side of the argument, to see Cap's side of the argument, and frankly to not necessarily care about either side of those arguments because he has his own agenda—and that's T'Challa, the Black Panther."

The Russos were equally eager to introduce Black Panther's unique skill set and complex character traits into the film. "Black Panther brings an intensity that none of the other characters have; there's a real profound energy and edge to the Panther," Joe Russo says. "Chadwick Boseman, who portrays T'Challa in the film, is amazing with conveying that emotion, that energy, through movement and without a lot of words. I think he's carved out a very distinctive character in the Marvel Cinematic Universe. It's not easy coming into the story where the first thing that you're dealing with is tragedy, because it shades the character in a very specific way from the word go. I think Chadwick has done an incredible job of also carving out an arc for himself in a very complicated and crowded movie."

Black Panther isn't the only character making his Marvel Cinematic Universe debut. As Captain America's team grows, Tony Stark begins to explore his options—hopefully finding someone who can bring a non-violent alternative the table. That person happens to be a 16-year-old kid from Queens: Peter Parker. Stark finds out Parker has created a web-fluid capable of, in Stark's mind, disarming Cap and his team